



GRASSROOTS EMPOWERMENT AND LIVELIHOOD INITIATIVE (GELI)

Local Roots. Lasting Impact.

COMPANY PROFILE

An indigenous, community-based non-governmental organisation bridging development partners, government, and the private sector to hard-to-reach communities across Zamfara State, North-West Nigeria.

Reaching the communities others cannot.

Headquarters: Gusau, Zamfara State, Nigeria

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Who We Are

The Grassroots Empowerment and Livelihood Initiative (GELI) is an indigenous, community-based non-governmental organisation founded to close the widening intervention gap in Zamfara State, North-West Nigeria. Born out of a deep, first-hand understanding of the security, social and economic realities on the ground, GELI exists to ensure that development, opportunity and reliable information reach the communities that need them most including those in local government areas that have become difficult or unsafe for external organisations to access.

We are built on a simple but powerful idea: the people best placed to serve Zamfara's communities are Zamfara's own sons and daughters. By recruiting and training qualified, educated indigenes from every local government area in the state, GELI provides a trusted local presence that national and international organisations, government agencies, donors, employers and commercial firms can rely on to deliver their programmes and reach their audiences safely, credibly and effectively.

Our work runs along three connected lines:

- **As an implementing partner**, we connect outside expertise and resources with grassroots access and local knowledge, delivering programmes in places our partners cannot safely reach themselves.
- **As a bridge to opportunity and markets**, we take the lead in sourcing the right candidates for employers and private firms recruiting anywhere in the state, and we mobilise credible local networks for commercial companies that need to reach hard-to-reach communities with their products and services.
- **As a self-funded community organisation**, we design and deliver our own programmes financed by GELI management, free to participants in education, health, job-opportunity awareness, government programme access, basic computer and artificial intelligence literacy, and public orientation on contemporary issues.

Our work is anchored on the following commitments:

- **Inclusive reach**: ensuring that no community is left behind because of where it is located or how difficult it is to reach;
- **Local ownership**: placing local people, local knowledge and local trust at the heart of every intervention;
- **Homegrown capacity**: creating dignified employment for educated indigenes drawn from every local government area in the state;
- **Opportunity and information**: making sure that young people in every ward know about the jobs, government interventions and digital skills that could change their circumstances;
- **Trusted partnership**: delivering the programmes of our partners with transparency, accountability and measurable results;
- **Uncompromising compliance**: safeguarding the people we work with, protecting the third-party data entrusted to us and securing the information we hold, in every engagement without exception;
- **Lasting commitment**: standing with the displaced, the out-of-school child, the unemployed graduate, the vulnerable family and the at-risk community for the long term.

Our Story and the Need We Serve

Zamfara State is passing through one of the most challenging periods in its history. Persistent insecurity has forced large numbers of families to flee their rural communities for the relative safety of local government headquarters and urban centres. Many of these displaced families have lost their farms, their livelihoods and their stability. Their children, once enrolled in school, now roam the streets, out of education and often reduced to begging for food. This has produced a deepening education crisis across the state.

The consequences extend far beyond the classroom. As insecurity persists, the state's education, health, agriculture and broader economic systems continue to decline together. Families that once fed themselves and their communities can no longer farm; clinics and schools in affected areas struggle to function; and opportunity narrows for an entire generation of young people.

At the very moment when these communities most need support, many national and international organisations have reduced, suspended or withdrawn their activities, understandably reluctant to expose their staff to the risks of travelling to affected local government areas. The result is a widening intervention gap: the communities in greatest need have become the hardest for outside help to reach.

A quieter crisis: opportunity and information

Alongside insecurity sits a second, quieter crisis. Thousands of educated young people across Zamfara's local government areas are unemployed not only because jobs are scarce, but because they never hear about the ones that exist. Federal and state empowerment schemes, loans, grants, skills programmes and recruitment drives are announced through channels that rarely reach the rural ward, and are too often mediated by middlemen who charge for access to something that is free. Employers in Gusau, Kaduna, Kano and Abuja report that they cannot find suitable candidates from these areas, while qualified indigenes sit at home unaware that recruitment is open.

At the same time, digital tools and now artificial intelligence are rapidly reshaping what employers expect of a candidate. Young people who have never used a computer are being pushed further behind before they begin, and communities with no reliable source of information on contemporary issues are left exposed to rumour, misinformation and outright fraud.

The commercial access gap

The same access problem constrains the private sector. Companies with products and services that would be genuinely useful to rural households agricultural inputs, financial and mobile-money services, telecommunications, health and nutrition products, solar and building materials cannot safely or credibly reach the hard-to-reach local government areas, and have no trusted local networks through which to introduce themselves. Communities lose access to goods, services and information; companies lose a market that would have paid for itself.

Our response

GELI was conceived as a direct, practical response to these gaps. Where it is unsafe for outsiders to travel, we are already there. Where local knowledge and community trust are essential, we already have them. Where opportunity exists but news of it does not travel, we carry it. By organising and training Zamfara's own qualified indigenes into a disciplined, professional workforce, GELI makes it possible for

development, employment and legitimate commerce to continue even in the places they had begun to leave behind.

Our Mission

To bridge the gap between development partners, government, employers and underserved communities in Zamfara State by deploying a trusted network of qualified indigenous personnel who can safely and effectively deliver education, health, agriculture, humanitarian and empowerment interventions even in the most difficult-to-reach areas; to open access to jobs, government programmes, digital and AI skills and reliable information for young people in every local government area; and to create meaningful, dignified employment for the people of Zamfara.

Our Vision

A Zamfara State where every community, no matter how remote or affected by insecurity, has access to quality education, healthcare, reliable information and real economic opportunity delivered by its own people, for its own people.

Core Values

Everything GELI does is guided by a clear set of values:

- **Local Ownership:** We believe lasting change is led by the people who live it. Local presence, local knowledge and local trust are our greatest assets.
- **Integrity & Accountability:** We act with honesty, transparency and accountability in every partnership, every project and every naira entrusted to us.
- **Safeguarding & Duty of Care:** The safety, dignity and protection of the people we work with especially children, women and others at risk comes before programme delivery, reputation or convenience.
- **Confidentiality & Data Protection:** Information entrusted to us by partners, communities and individuals is held securely, used only for its agreed purpose, and never disclosed without lawful authority.
- **Inclusion & Equity:** We serve all people without discrimination, reaching women, children, youth, persons with disabilities, the displaced and the vulnerable in equal measure.
- **Opportunity for All:** We believe information about work, training and government support is a public good, and we give it away freely.
- **Commitment & Resilience:** We stand with our communities through difficulty, and we deliver on what we promise.

- **Excellence & Learning:** We pursue the highest standards in our work and continually build the skills of our people and partners.

Our Approach: The Local Partner Model

What distinguishes GELI is our local partner model, a structured approach to delivering work where outside organisations cannot easily operate. Rather than asking partners to assume the risk of operating directly in volatile areas, we provide a ready, trained and trusted local workforce that delivers their programmes on their behalf, to their standards, and reports back transparently. The model works in five clear steps:

1. **Recruit locally:** We identify and recruit qualified, educated indigenes from every local government area in Zamfara State, building a workforce that already lives within and is trusted by the communities to be served.
2. **Train to partner standards:** Our partners brief and train our personnel on exactly how they want their services delivered their methodology, standards, tools, safeguarding requirements and reporting formats.
3. **Safeguard and secure before deployment:** Before any field activity begins, personnel are briefed on their safeguarding obligations, on informed consent, and on the handling of personal and partner data. Every engagement has a named safeguarding focal point and a documented data-handling protocol agreed in writing with the partner.
4. **Implement on the ground:** Our trained teams carry out the agreed activities directly in the field, including in local government areas that are inaccessible or unsafe for the partner's own staff to travel to.
5. **Monitor and report:** We collect data, document results and provide clear, timely reports giving partners full visibility of progress and verified evidence of impact, without putting their own staff at risk.

This model turns Zamfara's greatest operational challenge restricted access into a solvable problem. It allows partners, government and legitimate businesses to keep serving the communities that need them, while ensuring that the economic benefit of that work stays within the state, in the hands of its own people.

What We Offer

GELI provides five complementary streams of service. Together, they allow us to support development partners, assist government, connect employers and commercial firms to the communities they cannot otherwise reach, and act directly on behalf of the most vulnerable.

1. Local Partnership & Implementation Services

For national and international NGOs, donors, UN agencies and development contractors who wish to work in Zamfara but cannot safely deploy their own staff, GELI serves as a reliable local implementing partner. We can be engaged to:

- deliver and implement programme activities in hard-to-reach and insecure local government areas;
- provide trained, vetted local field staff, enumerators, facilitators and community mobilisers;
- receive and apply partner training, methodologies and standards with fidelity;
- conduct data collection, baseline and end-line surveys, and third-party monitoring and verification;
- manage community entry, stakeholder engagement and local logistics on the partner's behalf;
- provide regular field reports, documentation and verified evidence of delivery.

2. Government Support Services

GELI is equally available to support government ministries, departments and agencies in delivering services that require trusted human capital and grassroots reach across the state, including:

- community-based social services and welfare outreach;
- public awareness, sensitisation and behaviour-change campaigns;
- dissemination, mobilisation and enrolment support for federal and state empowerment programmes, loans, grants, stipends and recruitment schemes, so that eligible citizens in every ward actually hear about them and can apply;
- electoral and civic engagement support, including voter education and field mobilisation;
- data collection, enumeration and field verification for government programmes;
- any other service that requires a disciplined, locally-rooted workforce able to operate across all local government areas.

3. Talent Sourcing & Recruitment Support "Hire the Right Candidate"

For companies, private firms, contractors and institutions that want to recruit but cannot reach, reach into, or reliably verify candidates across Zamfara's local government areas, GELI takes the lead in sourcing the right people. Because we maintain trained focal personnel in every local government area, we can carry a vacancy into communities that no job board reaches, and then filter, verify and present only candidates who genuinely fit the role. We can be engaged to:

- **Advertise into every LGA:** publicise vacancies and recruitment drives simultaneously across all local government areas, in Hausa and English, through community, traditional, religious, educational and youth structures as well as digital channels;
- **Build and maintain a talent pool:** a structured, consent-based database of qualified indigenes searchable by local government area, discipline, qualification, skill and experience;
- **Screen and shortlist:** assess applications against the employer's stated criteria, competencies, grade and budget, and present a defensible shortlist with reasons;
- **Verify at source:** confirm credentials, residency, character references, disciplinary history and community standing in the candidate's own community a check no remote recruiter can replicate;

- **Run assessments locally:** coordinate written tests, practical assessments and interviews within the LGA, including venue, invigilation and logistics, so that able candidates are not excluded by the cost of travel;
- **Support onboarding and retention:** assist with documentation, relocation, orientation and post-placement follow-up through the probationary period;
- **Advise on local labour realities:** realistic pay expectations, skill availability, seasonality and retention conditions per local government area.

Our recruitment ethic. Recruitment support is delivered under a written service agreement, and GELI charges the engaging employer never the candidate. We do not accept payment, gifts or favours from applicants at any stage, we do not guarantee outcomes in exchange for anything, and any member of our personnel found soliciting from a candidate is dismissed and reported. Shortlisting is on merit against the criteria the employer sets, and candidate data is used only for the vacancy the candidate consented to.

4. Last-Mile Market Access & Community Activation

For commercial companies whose products and services cannot currently reach the hard-to-reach local government areas, GELI provides a credible route to market built on people the community already trusts. We can be engaged to:

- **Mobilise the right local partners:** identify, brief and coordinate the community influencers, traditional and religious leaders, women's groups, youth associations, cooperatives, agro-dealers and retailers through whom a product can be introduced with credibility;
- **Recruit and supervise community promoters:** engage, train and manage brand ambassadors, demonstrators and sales agents drawn from the target community itself, so the message arrives in the right voice and the right language;
- **Run awareness and demonstration activations:** product education, live demonstration and question-and-answer sessions in markets, ward centres, motor parks and community gatherings;
- **Scope the market:** consumer demand, purchasing patterns, pricing sensitivity, seasonality, existing distribution and competitor presence, LGA by LGA;
- **Map distribution and retail:** identify outlets, wholesalers and last-mile logistics options, and coordinate delivery into locations a company cannot itself access;
- **Report on results:** reach, uptake, consumer feedback and recommendations, with photographic and attendance evidence.

Our commercial ethic. All commercial activation is carried out in line with community norms, with the knowledge and consent of local authorities, and under the same safeguarding, data-protection and ethical-marketing standards as our development work. We will not promote any product or service that is unlawful, unsafe, misleading, exploitative in its pricing or credit terms, or otherwise harmful to the communities we serve and we will say so before a contract is signed rather than after.

5. Self-Sponsored Community Programmes

Beyond the work we do for partners and clients, GELI initiates and funds its own projects targeting the most vulnerable and least-informed people in the state, particularly the out-of-school children of displaced families, unemployed youth and communities without access to basic care or reliable information. Our self-sponsored focus is on:

- **Education:** getting displaced and out-of-school children back into learning through foundational literacy and numeracy support, learning materials and community-based education;
- **Health:** supporting basic health awareness, hygiene, nutrition and access to care for vulnerable women and children;
- **Training, orientation and public awareness:** a continuing, management-funded programme in job-opportunity awareness, federal government programmes and interventions, basic computer and AI literacy, and contemporary issues described in full in the next section.

Our Self-Sponsored Training and Public Awareness Programme

GELI's management funds and delivers, at no cost whatsoever to participants, a continuing programme of training, orientation and public awareness for young people and community members across Zamfara State. This programme is not donor-dependent and is not contingent on winning a contract: it is financed by the organisation's management as a deliberate investment in the state's people, and it runs whether or not a partner project is in place.

It exists because the gap it addresses is one nobody has been paid to close. Opportunity is announced in places our communities cannot hear it; government interventions are wrapped in procedure that nobody explains; the labour market has gone digital while whole wards have never touched a keyboard; and the issues shaping daily life are discussed everywhere except where their consequences land hardest. The programme rests on four pillars.

Pillar	Focus	What Participants Gain
1. Job Opportunity Awareness	Making visible the employment, apprenticeship and self-employment opportunities that exist in and beyond the state, and equipping participants to compete for them.	Knowledge of live vacancies, recruitment cycles and employer expectations; CV and application writing; interview preparation; credential and documentation readiness; how and where to search safely; how to recognise and refuse recruitment scams and "pay-for-a-job" fraud.
2. Federal Government Programmes and Interventions	Explaining, in plain Hausa and English, the federal and state programmes, loans, grants, stipends, skills schemes and recruitment drives that participants are entitled to apply for.	A practical understanding of what each programme offers, who qualifies, which documents are required, how and when to register, where to verify authenticity, and how to bypass the middlemen and impostors who charge for access to free schemes.
3. Basic Computer and Artificial Intelligence	Foundational digital skills and an honest, practical first introduction to	Keyboard, file and folder basics; word processing, spreadsheets and

Pillar	Focus	What Participants Gain
(AI) Literacy	AI tools designed for people who may never have used a computer.	presentations; email, internet search and safe browsing; smartphone productivity; how to use AI assistants responsibly for writing, learning, job search and small business; and a clear-eyed grounding in online safety, privacy, misinformation and the limits of AI.
4. Public Orientation and Awareness of Contemporary Issues	Helping communities understand and respond to the issues shaping their lives right now.	Civic responsibility and rights; peace, security consciousness and community cohesion; the value of education and of keeping children in school; health, hygiene and nutrition awareness; substance abuse prevention; climate and environmental change; digital fraud and misinformation; and the participation of women and girls in community and economic life.

How the programme is delivered

- in Hausa and English, by GELI personnel drawn from the participants' own local government areas, so instruction arrives in a familiar voice;
- in accessible community venues schools, ward centres, skills acquisition centres, and religious and traditional gathering places so that participation costs nothing but time;
- completely free of charge: no tuition, no registration fee, no "form fee", no material fee and no condition of any kind;
- open to young men and women alike, with deliberate outreach to girls, out-of-school youth, persons with disabilities and displaced people;
- computer and AI literacy sessions delivered using GELI's own equipment, and, where power or connectivity is limited, in offline-capable formats;
- structured with attendance records, pre- and post-session assessment and follow-up, so that impact can be evidenced rather than assumed;
- under the same safeguarding, consent and data-protection standards as every other GELI activity, including written consent for participation and for the use of photographs.

Why we fund it ourselves

Three reasons. It is the right thing to do, and it needed doing. It builds and continually refreshes the talent pool that our recruitment clients draw on, which means the young person we train today is the candidate we can credibly present tomorrow. And it earns our field teams the standing in the community that makes every other kind of work possible because our relationship with a community does not begin and end with a project cycle.

Our Thematic Focus Areas

Whether working for a partner, supporting government, serving a commercial client or running our own programmes, GELI is equipped to operate across a broad range of sectors:

Focus Area	What We Deliver
Education & Foundational Learning	Foundational literacy and numeracy, development of teaching and learning materials, teacher training and coaching, support for out-of-school and displaced children, and stakeholder and community mobilisation around education.
Health	Community health awareness, hygiene and sanitation promotion, nutrition sensitisation, maternal and child health outreach, and support for vulnerable groups including displaced families.
Agriculture & Food Security	Support to smallholder and displaced farmers, agricultural extension and good-practice training, food-security interventions, and livelihood restoration for households affected by insecurity.
Humanitarian Response	Support to internally displaced persons and host communities, distribution and relief support, community needs assessment, and protection-sensitive field delivery.
Employability, Recruitment & Talent Sourcing	Job-opportunity awareness, CV and interview readiness, LGA-wide vacancy advertisement, candidate sourcing, screening, verification and shortlisting for employers, local assessment logistics, and post-placement follow-up.
Digital & Artificial Intelligence Literacy	Basic computer skills, office productivity, internet and email, smartphone competence, responsible use of AI tools, online safety, privacy and misinformation awareness.
Civic Awareness & Contemporary Issues	Public orientation and sensitisation on civic rights and responsibilities, peace and security consciousness, education advocacy, health and nutrition, substance abuse, environmental change, and digital fraud and misinformation.
Market Access & Community Activation	Community mobilisation for commercial clients, promoter and agent recruitment and supervision, product awareness and demonstration, market and consumer scoping, retail and distribution mapping, and campaign reporting.
Research, Monitoring & Evaluation	Baseline, midline and end-line assessments, qualitative and quantitative data collection, key-informant interviews, focus group discussions, third-party monitoring and independent verification.
Community Awareness & Social Mobilisation	Sensitisation and behaviour-change campaigns, civic and electoral education, stakeholder engagement, and community entry and mobilisation.
Empowerment & Livelihoods	Skills and vocational training, youth and women's empowerment, economic inclusion, and support for self-reliance among at-risk and displaced populations.

Our People: A Workforce Drawn from Every Local Government

GELI's strength lies in its people. We deliberately recruit qualified and educated indigenes from every local government area of Zamfara State, so that wherever a programme, a vacancy or a campaign needs to reach, we have personnel who already belong to that community, speak its language, understand its customs and are trusted by its leaders and residents.

This approach delivers three benefits at once. First, it provides safe and credible access to areas that outsiders cannot easily reach. Second, it ensures interventions are culturally appropriate and genuinely accepted by the community. Third, it creates dignified, meaningful employment for educated young people across the state, keeping talent and economic opportunity at home and giving Zamfara's own people a direct stake in their state's recovery and development.

Every member of GELI personnel is recruited through a documented process that includes identity and address verification, credential checks, reference checks including a specific safeguarding reference and confirmation of standing in their own community. Before deployment, all personnel are trained, oriented and required to sign our Code of Conduct, our safeguarding and protection-from-sexual-exploitation-and-abuse commitment, and a binding confidentiality and data-protection undertaking. These obligations are refreshed annually and continue to bind them after their engagement ends.

Compliance, Safeguarding and Information Security

GELI's value to any partner rests entirely on being trusted with two things: people and information. We therefore treat compliance not as paperwork attached to a contract, but as the condition of our licence to operate. Every engagement development, government or commercial is delivered under the standards set out below, and we actively welcome partner audit, verification and unannounced spot-checks against them.

Safeguarding: Protecting the People We Work With

Safeguarding takes precedence over programme delivery, over reputation and over commercial convenience. Our position is unambiguous:

- **Zero tolerance:** GELI maintains zero tolerance of sexual exploitation, abuse and harassment (SEAH), of any form of abuse or exploitation of a child or adult at risk, and of the abuse of power by any member of personnel, associate, volunteer, promoter, consultant or downstream partner.
- **Recognised standards:** We align with the IASC Six Core Principles relating to Protection from Sexual Exploitation and Abuse, and we adopt our partners' own safeguarding policies and reporting requirements where these are more stringent than our own.
- **Signed commitments before deployment:** Every member of personnel signs the Code of Conduct and PSEAH commitment before any contact with a community, receives induction training on it, and repeats that training annually.
- **Child safeguarding:** No unsupervised one-to-one contact with children; a two-adult rule for all activities involving children; written parent or guardian consent for participation and for any

photography or filming; and adherence to the Child Rights Act and applicable state child protection provisions.

- **Safer recruitment:** Identity and address verification, credential checks, a specific safeguarding reference, disclosure of any prior disciplinary or misconduct history, and verification of community standing applied to field promoters and short-term enumerators exactly as to permanent staff.
- **Named focal point, and a woman to report to:** A designated Safeguarding Focal Point independent of programme delivery, with an alternate of the opposite gender, so that women and girls always have a woman to whom they can report.
- **Accessible reporting channels:** Multiple confidential routes a dedicated telephone line, the named focal point, a written complaints form and an anonymous channel publicised in Hausa and English in every community where we operate, in formats accessible to people who cannot read.
- **Survivor-centred response:** The safety, wishes, confidentiality, dignity and non-discrimination of the survivor guide every decision. Immediate referral to medical, psychosocial and legal support where wanted, and no pressure on a survivor to report to authorities.
- **Investigation and notification:** A documented investigation, disciplinary and referral procedure, with notification to the affected partner within the timeframe their contract specifies 24 or 48 hours as required and referral to the appropriate authorities where the law requires it.
- **Non-retaliation:** Anyone reporting a concern in good faith is protected from retaliation of any kind. Retaliation is itself a disciplinary offence.
- **Do no harm:** A conflict-sensitivity and do-no-harm assessment before entering any community, so that our presence does not expose participants, personnel or the community to risk.

Third-Party Data and Information Entrusted to Us

GELI routinely handles data that belongs to somebody else: beneficiary records for a development partner, applicant records for an employer, consumer data for a commercial client, enumeration data for a government agency. Our standing position is that we are custodians of that data and never its owners.

- **Lawful basis and purpose limitation:** Personal data is collected only where there is a lawful basis for doing so, and used only for the specific purpose agreed in writing with the data owner. Nothing else.
- **Informed consent:** Participants are told, in a language they genuinely understand, what is being collected, why, who will see it, how long it will be held and how to withdraw. Consent is recorded. For children, consent is obtained from a parent or guardian together with the child's own assent.
- **Data minimisation:** We collect the least data necessary for the agreed purpose. Sensitive personal data health, biometric, religious, political or similar is not collected without explicit written instruction and justification from the data owner.
- **Legal framework:** We comply with the Nigeria Data Protection Act (NDPA) 2023 and the directions of the Nigeria Data Protection Commission, and with the UK/EU GDPR or other regimes where a partner's obligations extend to them.

- **Written data processing agreements:** Every engagement involving personal data is governed by a data processing agreement or equivalent contractual clause specifying ownership, permitted use, security standards, sub-processing, retention, breach notification, and return or destruction on exit.
- **Binding confidentiality undertakings:** Every person with access to third-party data signs a confidentiality and non-disclosure undertaking that survives the end of their engagement with GELI.
- **No secondary use, ever:** Partner and client data is never reused for another engagement, shared with a third party, sold, or applied to GELI's own purposes. Recruitment data is never shown to a competing employer; one commercial client's market data is never shared with another.
- **Segregation and need-to-know access:** Data belonging to different partners is stored separately, under access rights granted strictly on a need-to-know basis, and access is logged.
- **Retention and disposal:** Data is retained only for the agreed period, then securely deleted or returned to the owner, with a signed certificate of destruction where the partner requires one.
- **Data subject rights:** Requests for access, correction, objection or erasure are logged on receipt and referred to the data owner for instruction within the agreed timeframe.
- **Imagery and case studies:** Photographs, film and personal stories are collected and used only with specific, separate, revocable written consent, and never in a way that could place a person at risk.

Information Security

Our security controls are designed to be proportionate to a field organisation working across fourteen local government areas, and to withstand a partner's due-diligence review:

- **Access control:** Unique named accounts, strong passwords enforced through a password manager, and multi-factor authentication on all email, cloud storage and data-collection platforms. Shared logins are prohibited.
- **Device security:** Full-disk encryption, enforced screen locks, current operating systems and anti-malware on every laptop and tablet, with remote wipe enabled on all mobile devices used for field data collection.
- **Encryption in transit and at rest:** Digital data collection is carried out on encrypted, authenticated platforms; paper forms are transported in sealed envelopes and held in locked storage until digitisation, then securely destroyed.
- **Approved channels only:** Personal email accounts, personal cloud storage, consumer messaging applications and personal USB drives are prohibited for third-party data. Transfers use only the channel and platform the partner specifies.
- **Least privilege and prompt revocation:** Access rights are role-based, reviewed quarterly, and revoked the same day a person leaves or changes role.
- **AI tool governance:** We teach AI literacy and we use AI tools, which makes us explicit about the risk. Personal, confidential or partner-identifiable data is never entered into a public AI assistant or any third-party tool not covered by an approved agreement. Approved AI use is confined to

non-sensitive drafting, learning and analysis, and all AI-assisted output is reviewed by a person before use.

- **Backup and continuity:** Encrypted backups on an agreed schedule, held separately from primary storage, with periodic restore testing and a documented continuity plan for loss of premises, power or connectivity.
- **Incident response:** A documented breach response procedure: immediate containment, assessment of risk to affected individuals, notification of the affected partner within the contractual window and of the Nigeria Data Protection Commission within the statutory 72-hour period where applicable, remediation, and a written post-incident report with corrective actions.
- **Physical security:** Locked offices and filing cabinets, controlled visitor access, clear-desk practice, and secure shredding of paper records.
- **Training:** Information security and data protection induction before deployment, and refresher training at least annually, with completion recorded.

Assurance, Audit and Partner Verification

- **A documented policy suite, kept current:** Safeguarding and PSEAH; Child Protection; Data Protection and Privacy; Information Security and Acceptable Use; Code of Conduct; Whistleblowing; Anti-Fraud, Bribery and Corruption; Conflict of Interest; and Complaints and Feedback.
- **Due diligence as routine:** We complete partner capacity assessments, due-diligence questionnaires and policy reviews as a normal part of contracting, not as an exception.
- **Open to audit:** Partners and clients may audit our records, systems, sites and personnel files relating to their engagement, on reasonable notice.
- **Annual self-assessment:** A yearly internal assessment against safeguarding and data-protection standards, with findings and a corrective action plan made available to partners on request.
- **Financial accountability:** Segregated project accounting, full narrative and financial reporting to the partner's format, and independent audit of the organisation's accounts.

Our Compliance Commitments at a Glance

Compliance Area	Our Standing Commitment
Safeguarding & PSEAH	Zero tolerance; signed Code of Conduct and PSEAH commitment for all personnel before deployment; named focal point plus opposite-gender alternate; confidential and anonymous reporting channels; survivor-centred response; partner notified within the contractual window.
Child protection	Written parent or guardian consent; two-adult rule; no unsupervised one-to-one contact; consent-based, risk-assessed use of imagery; compliance with the Child Rights Act and applicable state provisions.
Third-party data	Custodian, never owner. Lawful basis and purpose limitation; recorded informed consent; data minimisation; written data processing agreement for every engagement; no secondary use; segregation by partner; secure return or

Compliance Area	Our Standing Commitment
	certified destruction on exit.
Legal framework	Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023 and the directions of the Nigeria Data Protection Commission; GDPR and other partner regimes where applicable; Child Rights Act and applicable state child protection provisions.
Information security	Multi-factor authentication; encryption in transit and at rest; full-disk encryption and remote wipe on field devices; least-privilege, quarterly-reviewed access; approved transfer channels only; encrypted off-site backups.
AI and digital tools	No personal, confidential or partner-identifiable data in public AI tools; approved AI use limited to non-sensitive tasks; human review of all AI-assisted output.
Breach response	Immediate containment and risk assessment; partner notified within the contractual window; NDPC notified within 72 hours where applicable; remediation and a written post-incident report.
Recruitment integrity	Employer pays, never the candidate; no payment, gift or favour accepted from an applicant; merit-based shortlisting against employer criteria; candidate data used only for the vacancy consented to.
Commercial integrity	No promotion of unlawful, unsafe, misleading or exploitative products; activation only with the consent of local authorities; ethical-marketing and safeguarding standards applied to promoters and agents.
Assurance	Documented policy suite; open to partner audit on reasonable notice; annual self-assessment with corrective action plan; segregated project accounting and independent audit.

Why Partner With GELI

Organisations, agencies and companies choose to work through GELI because we offer something no external team can easily replicate: a genuine, trusted on-the-ground presence. Partnering with us means:

- **Access where others cannot go:** your programmes, vacancies and campaigns can continue to reach communities that would otherwise be cut off by insecurity;
- **Reduced risk to your team:** you keep your own staff out of harm's way while still delivering high-quality results;
- **Local trust and acceptance:** our personnel are accepted and trusted because they are part of the communities they serve;
- **The right candidate, not the nearest one:** employers get a shortlist sourced from all fourteen local government areas and verified in the candidate's own community;

- **A credible route to market:** commercial partners reach hard-to-reach consumers through voices those consumers already trust;
- **Compliance you can audit:** safeguarding, third-party data protection and information security are documented, contractually committed and open to your inspection;
- **Fidelity and accountability:** we deliver to your methodology and standards, with transparent monitoring, documentation and reporting;
- **Investment that stays local:** every engagement strengthens local capacity and creates employment for educated indigenes of the state;
- **A single, coordinated point of contact:** one trusted local partner across all fourteen local government areas of Zamfara State.

Leadership

GELI was founded by Abubakar Umar, an indigene of Gusau, Zamfara State, with hands-on experience in the education and development sector. Having worked with several non-governmental organisations delivering interventions in foundational skills, the development of teaching and learning materials, teacher training, stakeholder engagement and parent and community mobilisation, the founder brings both a technical understanding of how quality programmes are delivered and an intimate knowledge of the communities GELI exists to serve.

It is this combination of sector experience on one hand and deep local roots on the other that shapes GELI's mission to keep development, opportunity and information alive in Zamfara State, even in the most difficult of times. It is also the reason the organisation's management funds its training and public awareness programme from its own resources rather than waiting for a donor to make it possible.

Governance and Structure

GELI operates under a clear governance structure designed to ensure accountability, transparency, compliance and effective service delivery:

- **Board of Trustees:** provides strategic oversight, safeguards the organisation's mission, holds management accountable, and receives reports on safeguarding and data protection directly;
- **Management Team:** led by the Founder/Executive Director, responsible for day-to-day operations, partnerships and programme quality;
- **Safeguarding Focal Point:** a designated officer, independent of programme delivery, with a direct reporting line to the Board and an opposite-gender alternate, responsible for safeguarding policy, training, reporting channels and case management;
- **Data Protection Officer:** responsible for data processing agreements, consent processes, retention and disposal, breach response, and liaison with the Nigeria Data Protection Commission and with partners on data matters;
- **Programme & Technical Staff:** organised by sector education, health, agriculture, humanitarian, research and monitoring, digital and AI literacy and coordinated centrally from the Gusau headquarters;

- **Talent & Recruitment Desk:** maintains the consent-based talent pool, manages employer engagements, and runs advertisement, screening, verification and assessment logistics across the local government areas;
- **Commercial Partnerships Desk:** manages market access and activation engagements, promoter recruitment and supervision, and ethical-marketing review of every commercial proposal before acceptance;
- **Local Government Field Network:** trained local personnel based across all fourteen local government areas, who form the operational backbone of every intervention, vacancy drive and campaign.

Get In Touch

We would be glad to explore how we can partner with you as a development partner, a government agency, an employer looking for the right candidate, or a company seeking to reach communities others cannot. Please reach out to us:

Contact	Details
Organisation	Grassroots Empowerment and Livelihood Initiative (GELI)
Head Office	Office address: No. 14, 15 and 16 AA Master Plaza, Canteen Road, Gusau, Zamfara State.
Phone	+234 8026444208, 0813616593, 08116450291, 08069020473
Email	info@geli.ng
Recruitment enquiries	recruitment@geli.ng
Commercial partnerships	partnerships@geli.ng
Safeguarding concerns	safeguarding@geli.ng
Website / Social	www.geli.ng • social media handles @geli.ng
CAC Registration	Reg. No: 9848369

Local Roots. Lasting Impact.

Reaching the communities others cannot, by the people of Zamfara, for the people of Zamfara.